

5.3 THE NARROWING WINDOW TO CROSS THE DIVIDE

Takeaway: The window for crossing the GenAI Divide is rapidly closing. Enterprises are locking in learning-capable tools. Agentic AI and memory frameworks (like NANDA and MCP) will define which vendors help organizations cross the divide versus remain trapped on the wrong side.

Enterprises are increasingly demanding systems that adapt over time. Microsoft 365 Copilot and Dynamics 365 are incorporating persistent memory and feedback loops. OpenAI's ChatGPT memory beta signals similar expectations in general-purpose tools.

Startups that act quickly to close this gap, by building adaptive agents that learn from feedback, usage, and outcomes, can establish durable product moats through both data and integration depth. The window to do this is narrow. In many verticals, pilots are already underway.

The infrastructure to support this transition is emerging through frameworks like Model Context Protocol (MCP), Agent-to-Agent (A2A), and NANDA, which enable agent interoperability and coordination. These protocols create market competition and cost efficiencies by allowing specialized agents to work together rather than requiring monolithic systems. And these frameworks form the foundation of the emerging Agentic Web, a mesh of interoperable agents and protocols that replaces monolithic applications with dynamic coordination layers.

In the next few quarters, several enterprises will lock in vendor relationships that will be nearly impossible to unwind. This 18-month horizon reflects consensus from seventeen procurement and IT sourcing leaders we interviewed, supported by analysis of public procurement disclosures showing enterprise RFP-to-implementation cycles ranging from two to eighteen months. Organizations investing in AI systems that learn from their data, workflows, and feedback are creating switching costs that compound monthly.

"We're currently evaluating five different GenAI solutions, but whichever system best learns and adapts to our specific processes will ultimately win our business. Once we've invested time in training a system to understand our workflows, the switching costs become prohibitive." - CIO, \$5B Financial Services Firm

6 CROSSING THE GENAI DIVIDE: HOW THE BEST BUYERS SUCCEED

Organizations that successfully cross the GenAI Divide approach AI procurement differently, they act like BPO clients, not SaaS customers. They demand deep customization, drive adoption from the front lines, and hold vendors accountable to business metrics. The most successful buyers understand that crossing the divide requires partnership, not just purchase.

Across our interviews, one insight was clear: the most effective AI-buying organizations no longer wait for perfect use cases or central approval. Instead, they drive adoption through